Global Markets Daily: Not Your 2022 European Gas Crisis

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- North West Europe[1], the region that sets the European natural gas price benchmark (TTF), is about to start the winter with the lowest level of gas inventories in 14 years, against a backdrop of still low and highly uncertain Middle East liquefied natural gas (LNG) supply.
- Reduced Strait of Hormuz LNG flows impact up to 300 mcm/d of supply (19% of the 2025 global LNG supply), a similar-scale shock compared the 330 mcm/d curtailment of Russian gas exports back in 2022.
- We still see risks to our 70 EUR/MWh base case year-end forecast for TTF (currently trading at 87 EUR/MWh) skewed to the upside, and recommend that investors seeking to hedge near-term upside to European natural gas prices get exposure via TTF 1Q27 call spreads. Nevertheless, even under our tight-supply/cold winter scenario we would expect TTF to rally to 150 EUR/MWh, well below the 2022 300+ EUR/MWh highs. This is due to five main drivers: (1) Higher Ex-Mideast LNG supply; (2) higher LNG import capacity in NW Europe; (3) higher nuclear and renewable generation in NW Europe; (4) lower NW Europe natural gas demand; and (5) reduced European government intervention.

Not Your 2022 European Gas Crisis

Although the ongoing Mideast LNG supply shock is of similar scale to the 2022 curtailment of Russian natural gas supply to Europe, while NW Europe faces lower gas inventories now vs then, we believe that five mitigating factors are likely to keep European natural gas prices (TTF) well below the 300+ EUR/MWh highs observed in 2022.

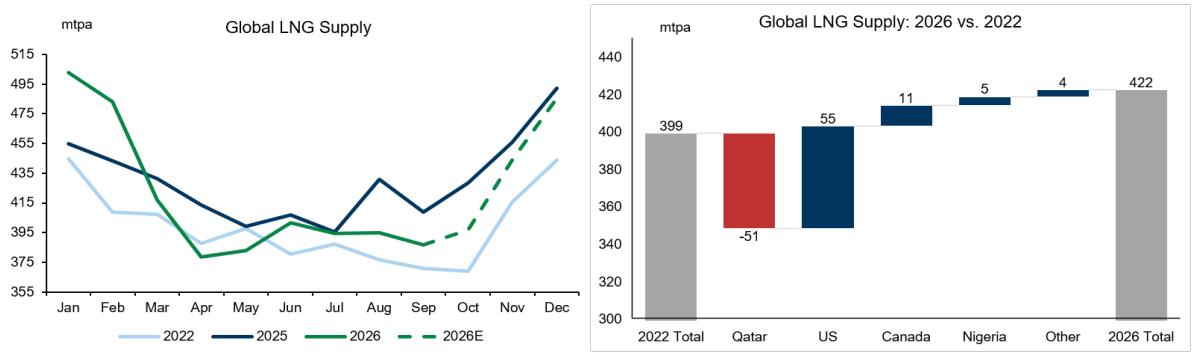
1. Higher Ex-Mideast LNG supply. Despite the sharp drop in Middle East LNG supply following the start of the Iran conflict, global LNG supply is actually up 6% from 2022, driven by a 23% rise in LNG supply in the rest of the world (Exhibit 1). On net, global LNG supply is up 87 mcm/d (23 mtpa) vs 2022. We expect US LNG supply in particular to grow another 65% between now and 2030.

[1] Our North West Europe definition includes the UK, Belgium, France, the Netherlands and Germany.

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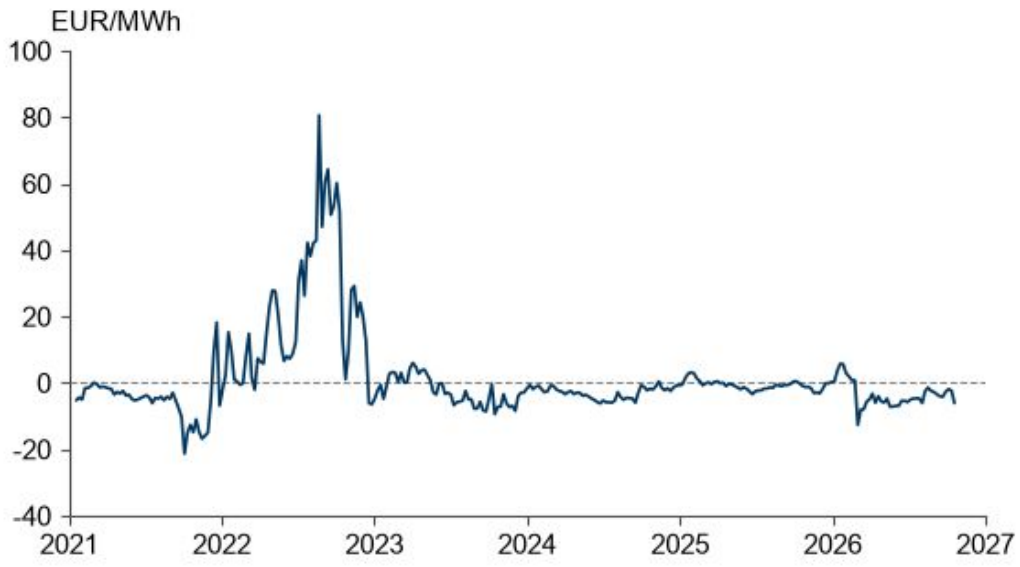
Exhibit 1: Despite a sharp drop in Mideast exports, global LNG supply is up 6% from 2022 levels
Mtpa



Source: Kpler, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

2. Higher LNG import capacity in NW Europe. In 2022 NW Europe had limited LNG import capacity[2], as the region had historically relied on pipeline gas imports as its primary source of gas supply. As a result, when NW Europe tried to replace curtailed Russian pipeline gas with incremental LNG imports in 2022, it quickly ran into bottlenecks, driving TTF higher, at times more than 60 EUR/MWh above Asia LNG prices — in sharp contrast with its typical modest regional discount — to trigger domestic gas demand destruction to help balance the market (Exhibit 2). Since then, Germany and the Netherlands have led a 78% increase in NW Europe LNG import capacity, allowing the region to receive higher LNG import volumes this time around to help manage gas inventories through the winter.

Exhibit 2: LNG infrastructure bottlenecks drove TTF well above LNG prices in 2022 to trigger European gas demand destruction to help balance the market
TTF minus Asia LNG spot prices (JKM)



Source: ICE, S&P Global Commodity Insights, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

3. Higher nuclear and renewable generation in NW Europe. NW Europe nuclear

[2] Because liquefied natural gas needs to be turned from a liquid (inside the tankers) back into a gaseous state before flowing through the grid, specialized regasification facilities are required in order to bring LNG onshore.

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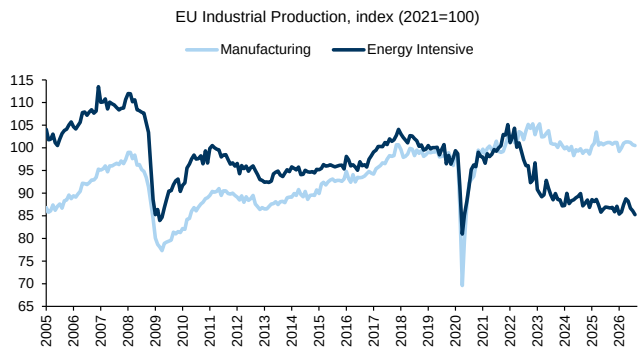
generation was particularly low in 2022, as France faced widespread planned and unplanned outages, supporting gas demand for power 74% (47 mcm/d) above what we would have expected that summer if nuclear generation had kept stable yoy[3]. This summer, nuclear and renewable power generation are higher, while power demand is lower than in 2022. Even though currently low river levels in France have again moderated nuclear generation, a 41% (13 GW) rise in renewable power generation has helped lower gas demand for power by 33% (36 mcm/d) vs 2022 levels. This relative drop in gas demand should widen in the winter if river levels, and hence nuclear power generation, improve.

4. Lower NW Europe natural gas demand. While NW European gas supply is net down vs pre-2022 levels, as the region never fully offset the combined loss of Russian gas and Dutch production since 2022, gas demand is down more. Specifically, in addition to the drop in gas demand for power prompted by increased alternative energy sources discussed above, industrial and residential/commercial usage of gas are also structurally lower than in 2022.

This is primarily driven by the shutdown of energy-intensive industrial capacity since 2022 following a collapse in margins when TTF rallied at the time (Exhibit 3), combined with an increase in heat pump home installations, and a shift in heating behavior, as household energy bills rose (Exhibit 4). On net, we expect NW European demand for gas to average 16% lower this winter vs average pre-2022 levels.

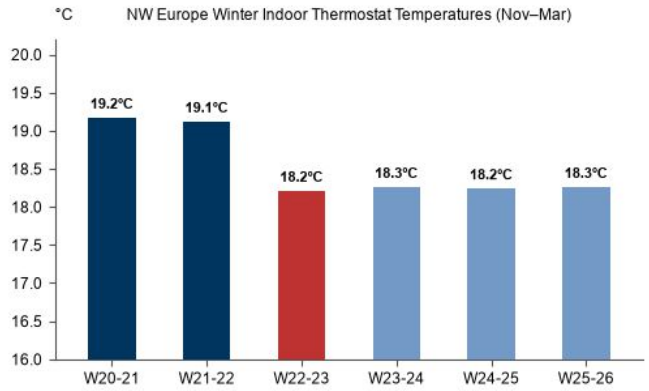
This structural drop in European gas demand has also lowered in our view the optimum storage target ahead of the winter. NW Europe can fill storage up to 15pp lower than the pre-2022-energy-crisis average fill of 88% ahead of the winter, while preserving the same winter coverage. This year we estimate NW European gas storage will not meet that target, however, reaching only 63% fill, 25pp below the pre-2022 average.

Exhibit 3: European energy-intensive industrial activity has not recovered from the 2022 shock



Source: Haver, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: Smart thermostat data suggest winter indoor temperatures are now kept nearly 1C lower vs 2022



Data refer to Tado customers only. Results hold for total Europe.

Source: Tado, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

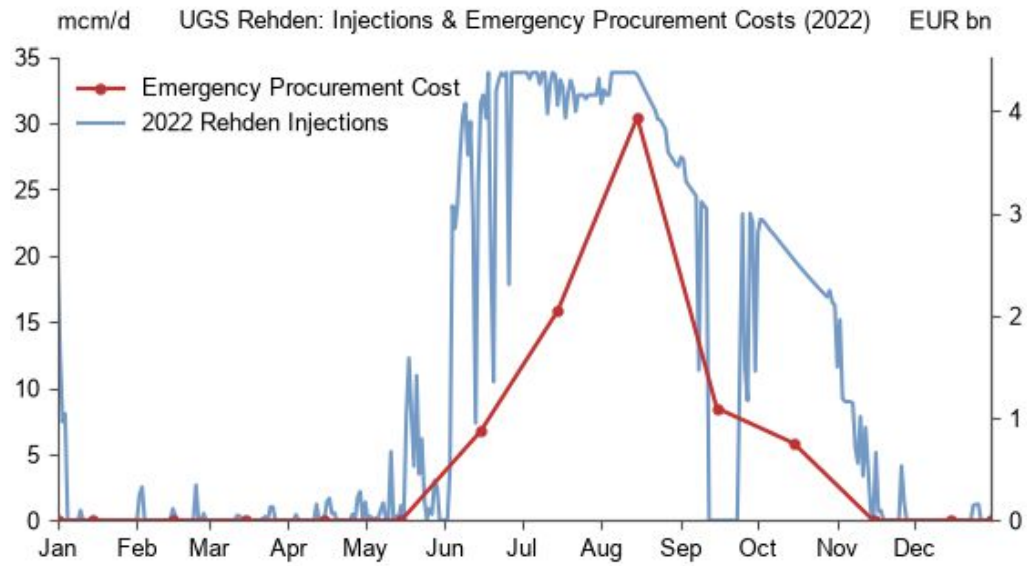
5. Reduced European government intervention. During the 2022 European gas crisis the EU enacted regulation to require member states to fill their aggregate storage to at

[3] We note that the 47 mcm/d low-nuclear-generation support to gas demand for power in 2022 was in large part ultimately offset by lower electricity demand and higher fuel switching away from gas and into coal driven by high gas prices at the time.

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least 80% by end-Oct22. This created sizable inelastic demand for natural gas (to be injected into storage) at a time when supply was tight, also contributing to the peak of the TTF rally in late summer 2022. For example, German emergency gas buying at the time increased the country's peak-summer domestic demand for natural gas by 23% relative to 2021 levels. This year's intervention has been much more limited, with the German state-owned energy company SEFE required to buy approximately 0.7 Bcm of gas for storage injections, well below the 4.5 Bcm of emergency purchases observed in 2022.

Exhibit 5: Government-mandated gas purchases increased Sum22 demand for gas, contributing to the TTF rally at the time
Mcm/d (left), EUR billions (right)



Source: Gas Infrastructure Europe (GIE), Trading Hub Europe, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

We take these mitigating factors into account and we estimate that, if Persian Gulf LNG exports continue to improve over the course of the winter — as they have over the past six weeks — which is our base case, TTF can balance the market at 70 EUR/MWh through 4Q26, 20% down from current levels, and move lower still, into the mid-40 EURs/MWh, in Q1 as a result of higher Hormuz supply.

However, a scenario where Middle East LNG supply improvement halts or the European winter realizes colder-than-average would create a bigger winter deficit in the market, requiring higher TTF (and LNG) prices to incentivize further LNG demand destruction. Specifically, we estimate TTF could rally to 150 EUR/MWh by year-end in a scenario where winter Persian Gulf LNG exports don't improve beyond 25% of normal and winter realizes 1 std. dev. colder than average (Exhibit 6). Although this would mean TTF prices approximately 70% above current levels, the market would still be far below the 2022 300+ EUR/MWh highs.

We recommend that investors seeking to hedge near-term upside to European natural gas prices get exposure via TTF 1Q27 call spreads, given that (1) implied volatility and call skew are high, and (2) we would expect 1Q27 to be the part of the TTF futures curve likely to increase the most following a potential early winter cold shock.

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Exhibit 6: We continue to see risks to our winter TTF forecast skewed to the upside

Peak Winter (Dec26) GS Price Scenarios for European Natural Gas (TTF), €/MWh			
		Mideast Supply	
		Base Case	Low Supply
2026-2027 Winter	Base Case (10-Year Average)	70	105
	1 St. Dev. Colder Than Average	115	150
	1 St. Dev. Warmer Than Average	45	90

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

TRADE IDEAS

Best Trade Ideas Across Assets

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1. Stay short AUD/NZD, via 6m (14 Jan 2027) 1.1650 puts, opened July 14, 2026, at 1.2000, currently trading at 1.233.
2. Stay long NIFTY Banks vs. short NIFTY Pharma, opened July 15, 2026, at 100 in local currency (INR), with a target at 115 and a stop at 90, currently trading at 97.
3. Stay short PLN/HUF, opened August 5, 2026, at 84.12, with a target at 80.5 and a stop at 87, currently trading at 83.85.
4. Stay short EUR/AUD, opened September 4, 2026, at 1.6123, with a target at 1.5750 and a stop at 1.6520, currently trading at 1.5980.
5. Stay long INR/IDR, opened September 4, 2026, at 187, with a target at 200 and a stop at 178, currently trading at 191.
6. Stay short SGD/CNH, opened September 4, 2026, at 5.29, with a target at 5.00 and a stop at 5.50, currently trading at 5.23.
7. Pay CHF 1y1y against EUR 1y1y, opened September 11, 2026, at 3.02, with a target at 2.65 and a stop at 3.02, currently trading at 2.99.
8. Receive 5Y HUF IRS, opened 17 September, 2026, at 5.50%, with a target at 4.90% and a stop at 5.80%, currently trading at 5.52%.
9. 2s10s PLN IRS steepeners, opened 17 September, 2026, at 61bp, with a target at 100bp and a stop at 45bp, currently trading at 56bp.
10. Stay long in equal weight BUX Index and ASE Index vs. short PX Index, opened 17 September, 2026, at 100 in USD, with a target of 115 and a stop at 90, currently trading at 99.
11. Stay long MXMU Energy vs. Industrials, opened 17 September, 2026, at 100 in USD,

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with a target at 115, and a stop at 90, currently trading at 108.

12. Pay 5s on the 2s5s10s fly JGB, opened 18 September, 2026, at -8.6bp, with a target at 2bp, and a stop at -13bp, currently trading at -8.1bp.
13. Stay long MYR/THB, opened 18 September, 2026, at 8.14, with a target at 8.60, and a stop at 7.80, currently trading at 8.23.
14. Receive 2Y KRW IRS, opened 18 September, 2026, at 3.97%, with a target at 3.60%, and a revised stop at 3.97%, currently trading at 3.78%.
15. IRZ6IRU7 flatteners, opened 02 October, 2026 at 19bp, with a target at -5bp, and a stop at 15bp, currently trading at 6bp.
16. Receive 10y on 5s10s30s SOFR fly, opened 9 October, 2026 at 2bp, with a target at -4bp and a stop at 4bp, currently trading at 1bp.
17. Long EGP and NGN against the USD, as an equally weighted basket, opened October 16, 2026, at 0%, with a total return target at 7%, and a revised stop at -3%, currently trading at -0.8%.

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